

Just like its predecessors, PlayStation 4 went on to become the bestselling console of its generation by having sold more than 40 million consoles by May 2016 and amassing critical praise from the whole industry and gamers.

Xbox One

Xbox launched its 8th gen console right on the heels of PlayStation 4 in 2013. Based on the same APU developed by AMD that powers the PS4, Xbox one was significantly better than its predecessor not only in terms of hardware but also the features it offered.

Microsoft knew it was not only fighting consoles, but also a host of other entertainment devices including smart TVs and set-top boxes. And to fight this war, Xbox One offered a host of multimedia features. The new console could not only playback Blu-rays, DVDs and CDs, but also let you connect your set-top box to it and pass the feed via a HDMI pass-through, making One a universal device of sorts.

Microsoft's popular online service Xbox Live was also given an upgrade. It now featured cloud storage that not only lets you store your games and saved content, but also music, movies and other files. Players can download a number of useful applications like the Upload Studio app that lets you record and edit the last 5 minute of your gameplay footage and share it with the online community.

The device received favorable reviews and provided good competition to the PS4. More than 18 million Xbox One have been shipped until last year putting it on 2nd position behind the PlayStation

This generation of console didn't have a lot of innovation to offer, but this is not to say that it wasn't significantly better than the last one. The better hardware meant better looking games and the better online integration across all platforms helped these consoles survive this generation of multitasking devices. Now, we have to wait and see what the upcoming generations of consoles have to offer. **d**